

Cheddar cheese coins/cheese pennies

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Ingredients

- **8 ounces (2 cups)** extra-sharp cheddar cheese, shredded
- **1 1/2 cups** all-purpose flour
- **1 tablespoon** cornstarch (helps make them flaky and buttery)
- **1/2 teaspoon** kosher salt
- **1/4 teaspoon** cayenne pepper (optional, for a hint of spice)
- **1/4 teaspoon** paprika
- **8 tablespoons (1 stick)** unsalted butter, cut into 8 pieces and chilled
- **3 tablespoons** cold water
- **Optional:** Everything bagel seasoning or sesame seeds for coating

Instructions

1. **Combine dry ingredients and cheese:** In the bowl of a food processor, pulse the cheddar, flour, cornstarch, salt, cayenne pepper (if using), and paprika until well combined, about 30 seconds.
2. **Add butter:** Scatter the chilled butter pieces over the mixture. Pulse until the mixture resembles wet sand.
3. **Form dough:** With the food processor running, gradually add the cold water, processing just until the dough comes together in a ball, about 10 seconds. Do not overmix.
4. **Chill the dough:** Transfer the dough to a clean surface and divide it in half. Roll each half into a log, about 1 to 1.5 inches in diameter and 9-10 inches long. Wrap the logs tightly in plastic wrap and refrigerate until firm, at least 1 hour or up to 3 days. You can also freeze the logs for up to a month.
5. **Preheat oven:** Adjust oven racks to the upper-middle and lower-middle positions and preheat the oven to 350°F (175°C). Line two baking sheets with parchment paper.
6. **Slice and arrange:** Unwrap the logs and slice crosswise into 1/4-inch-thick coins. Place the coins on the prepared baking sheets, spaced about 1/2 inch apart.
7. **Bake:** Bake for 22 to 28 minutes, or until the edges are light golden brown and crisp, rotating the baking sheets halfway through the baking time.
8. **Cool and store:** Let the cheese coins cool completely on the baking sheets or a wire rack. They will crisp up as they cool. Store in an airtight container at room temperature for up to 3 days.